

Question 56 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse how the choice among on-the-job, off-the-job, and e-learning methods can affect training outcomes.

Answer

Method choice affects learning quality, transfer, cost, motivation and therefore outcomes at all Kirkpatrick levels.

- 1. OJT outcomes:** Strong transfer and job relevance; outcomes suffer if coaches are unskilled or production pressure blocks practice.
- 2. Off-the-job outcomes:** Better conceptual learning and safe practice; outcomes suffer if the classroom is isolated from work (low level 3).
- 3. E-learning outcomes:** Consistent knowledge delivery and tracking; outcomes suffer with poor design, no interaction, or low completion.
- 4. Match to objective:** Motor skills favour OJT/simulation; interpersonal skills favour role play; information updates favour e-learning.
- 5. Learner factors:** New employees may need structured off-the-job; experienced staff may prefer OJT or micro e-learning.
- 6. Blended superiority:** Combining methods often yields better learning and behaviour than any single method.
- 7. Climate interaction:** Even the best method fails if the workplace punishes new behaviour.
- 8. Analytical point:** Outcomes are not determined by method labels but by fit to need, quality of execution, and transfer support.

Conclusion. Method choice is a strategic HRD decision: it shapes what is learned and whether it appears in job performance.